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FROM THE EDITOR

Issue 47.2 of the *Journal of Space Law* provides thought-provoking scholarship, addressing critical questions in our field. As we stand at the threshold of a new era in space exploration, this issue reflects the deep scope, complexity and urgency of governing humanity's activities beyond Earth.

The issue starts with a question: what is a celestial body? It seems simple enough until you consider the legal stakes tied to planets, asteroids, and everything in between. This article digs into the definitions that shape treaties and policies, a puzzle that's been close to my heart since my son first asked me about asteroid mining years ago. Next, we explore the impact of special relativity on law in deep space missions. When time itself bends at relativistic speeds, how do we apply jurisdiction or enforce contracts? Our third article applies Michel Foucault's theories to the growing commercial space sector, examining how power and regulation intersect as corporations vie for dominance in orbit. We then turn to UAPs—no longer UFOS, but unidentified aerial phenomena—and their legal implications. Whether advanced technology or something else, UAPs force us to consider how space law adapts to the unknown, raising questions of sovereignty, security and evidence. Shifting focus, the issue carries on with a comparative assessment of Chinese and US approaches to uncontrolled reentry of space objects. Our exploration then continues with an assessment of space-defense relationships in international organizations and concludes with a high-level overview of intellectual property in space

Editing is always a privilege, a chance to engage with brilliant minds pushing the boundaries of space law. A thanks to our authors, peer reviewers and student editors for your tremendous contributions. I hope the Journal continues to inspire you to look upward—not just in wonder, but with a commitment to shaping a legal framework worthy of the stars.

Michelle L.D. Hanlon
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